Hooper Markert

St. Louis, Missouri | hooper.markert@gmail.com
hoopermarkert.github.io | GitHub | Google Scholar

Education

Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, MO — Expected May 2027
M.A. in Economics

Columbia University, New York, NY — May 2025
B.A. in Neuroscience and Behavior
Magna cum laude; Phi Beta Kappa

Selected Graduate Coursework

PhD Quantitative Methods I (8710); Graduate Econometrics; Graduate Macroeconomics; Graduate Microeconomics; Macroeconomics of Inequality

Research Interests

Development economics; Applied microeconomics; Economics of education

Research Experience

Center for Research in Education for Development (CRED) — Jan. 2025–Present
Research Assistant; Strategic Program and Operations Manager

- Research the processes that inform the construction of successful reflection spaces that foster collaborative, intentional, and self-reflective teachers trained in the *Learning to Learn* program, an intervention with striking efficacy as demonstrated by Vesall Nourani's RCT.
- Collaborate with the Harvard Embedded Development Lab (EDL) on action-research projects, grant proposals, and ongoing evaluation of the *Learning to Learn* program.

Fundación para la Aplicación y Enseñanza de la Ciencia (FUNDAEC) — Oct. 2025–Apr. 2026
Christianson Fellow
Cali, Colombia

- Assisted with the *Growing Hope* program, supported by the Rockefeller Foundation, aimed at addressing food sovereignty in the Norte del Cauca region of Colombia.
- Supported a systematic reflection of the *Preparation for Social Action (PSA)* program across Colombia.

Prior Research Experience

Gabriele Bartoli Brain Tumor Laboratory, Columbia University — 2024–2025
Department of Neurosurgery
Advisors: Drs. Jeffrey Bruce and Peter Canoll

Kaplitt Laboratory, Cornell University — 2024–2025
Department of Neurosurgery
Advisor: Dr. Michael Kaplitt

Beierle Laboratory, University of Alabama at Birmingham — 2017–2022
Division of Pediatric Surgery, Department of Surgery
Advisor: Dr. Elizabeth Beierle

Selected Publications in Biomedical Research

Selected from 20 peer-reviewed publications in biomedical research. Complete publication list

1. Wadhwani N*, **Markert HR***, Marayati R, et al. "PIM447 inhibits oncogenesis and potentiates cisplatin effects in hepatoblastoma." *Journal of Pediatric Surgery.* 2021. **Equal contribution.*
2. Beierle AM, Quinn CH, **Markert HR**, et al. "Rapid Characterization of Solid Tumors Using Resonant Sensors." *ACS Omega.* 2022.
3. Quinn CH, Julson JR, **Markert HR**, et al. "Oncolytic virotherapy augments self-maintaining natural killer cell line cytotoxicity against neuroblastoma." *Cancer Immunology, Immunotherapy.* 2024.
4. Quinn CH, Julson JR, Erwin MH, **Markert HR**, et al. "Investigation of an oncolytic herpes simplex virus as a potential therapeutic agent for gastroenteropancreatic neuroendocrine neoplasms." *Scientific Reports.* 2025.
5. Bownes LV, Williams AP, Marayati R, Stafman LL, **Markert H**, et al. "EZH2 inhibition decreases neuroblastoma proliferation and *in vivo* tumor growth." *PLoS ONE.* 2021.
6. Stafman LL, Williams AP, Marayati R, Aye JM, **Markert HR**, et al. "Focal Adhesion Kinase Inhibition Contributes to Tumor Cell Survival and Motility in Neuroblastoma Patient-Derived Xenografts." *Scientific Reports.* 2019.

Selected Biomedical Research Presentations

Markert HR, Bownes LV, Julson JR, et al. "PP2A Activation Decreases Viability and Stemness of Neuroendocrine Tumor Cells." Academic Surgical Congress, Houston, TX — Feb. 2023

Markert HR, Quinn CH, Beierle AM, et al. "LC Resonant Sensor Differentiation of Intestinal Tissue." Academic Surgical Congress, Orlando, FL — Feb. 2022

Markert HR, Quinn CH, Beierle AM, et al. "Resonant Frequencies as a Means of Detecting Metastatic Activity and Characterizing Pediatric Tumor Type." Academic Surgical Congress, Virtual — Feb. 2021

Markert HR, Marayati R, Williams AP, et al. "Evaluation of a Novel PIM Inhibitor in Human Hepatoblastoma Cells." Academic Surgical Congress, Orlando, FL — Feb. 2020

Fellowships & Honors

Selected Baccalaureate Speaker, Columbia University — 2025
Christianson Fellowship, InterExchange — 2025

Grant Development & Research Support

Echidna Giving, $120,000 — 2026
Contributed to development of successful grant proposal supporting [PROGRAM / RESEARCH PROJECT].

Two Wings Foundation, $15,000 — 2026
Contributed to development of successful research support proposal for [PROJECT / RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIP].

Teaching, Mentoring & Service

Seminar Facilitator, Institute for Studies in Global Prosperity 2026–Present
Facilitate undergraduate seminars on social and economic development.

Co-Founder, Radiant Youth Foundation 2025–Present
Co-founded a nonprofit supporting educational opportunities for youth from underserved communities.

Selected Invited Talks

"Bahá'u'lláh's Teachings Find Expression in the Bhagavad Gita," Corinne True Center for Bahá'í History Nov. 2024

Technical Skills

Programming & Statistical Software: Python (numerical modeling, economic simulation, dynamic programming); Stata (regression analysis, statistical inference, data management); MATLAB (data processing and scripting); LaTeX(formal writing, beamer presentations)

Quantitative Methods: OLS estimation, hypothesis testing, value-function iteration, dynamic optimization, growth and convergence analysis.

Geospatial Analysis: ArcGIS (census-tract mapping, spatial overlays, buffer analysis, geographic data integration).

Languages: English (native); Spanish (advanced)